

EMINENT DOMAIN

Feature Film • Psychological Thriller / Drama • Atlanta-Set • Female-Led Ensemble

A photographer starting over in Atlanta takes a job documenting a historic Black neighborhood before it's erased by redevelopment, and slowly realizes the man stalking her has been erasing women like her for years, in every city his company's clients wanted to forget.

In the vein of *Fatal Attraction* (TV One) meets *The Family Business* (BET+), a survivor thriller with the true-crime pulse Urban One's audience already watches every Monday night, and the ensemble community stakes BET+ built its slate on.

THE WORLD

Ashby Grove is a hundred-and-forty-year-old Black neighborhood on Atlanta's BeltLine, the kind of block where everybody still knows whose porch is whose, and who used to sit in the balcony of the shuttered Harp Theater because the main floor wasn't open to them yet. It's also six holdout parcels away from a demolition permit. The neighborhood isn't a backdrop for this story, it's the reason the antagonist is standing on this particular street in the first place, and the reason the women who live there see him before any institution does.

SYNOPSIS

MAGGIE SULLIVAN, 29, flees a controlling three-year relationship in Griffin, Georgia, for the anonymity of Atlanta, where her oldest friend TAYLOR SIMPSON, 28, a graphic designer and housing-justice organizer, takes her in. A trial assignment for a boutique architecture firm becomes her healing: documenting Ashby Grove, a historic neighborhood being quietly bought out ahead of a demolition permit for its anchor building, the Harp Theater.

What Maggie doesn't know is that the developer's security consultant, MORRISON MCGEE, 43, has already noticed her. Morrison isn't hired to watch people, he's hired to monitor vacant property for the firm acquiring Ashby Grove parcel by parcel. For months he's used that access, and a stranger's easy charm, to insert himself into Maggie's life as a mentor and confidant. He's done this before, in three other cities, to three other women who made the mistake of pointing a camera at something his clients needed to disappear.

As Maggie's own reflection starts showing up in her film and Taylor's housing-justice casework starts overlapping with Maggie's shoot list, the two women realize they're standing inside the same story: a corporation quietly erasing a neighborhood, and the man it hired quietly erasing the women who document it. With the block's own eyes, ears, and institutional memory, embodied in its matriarch, ODESSA FAIR, 70s, on their side, Maggie and Taylor build a case Morrison can't hack, wipe, or talk his way out of, and set a trap in the one place he can't resist showing up: the theater, on the night Atlanta decides whether Ashby Grove keeps its history at all.

THEMES

- Reclaiming safety and agency after intimate partner abuse
- Whose history gets preserved, and who profits when it doesn't
- Community memory as protection no institution can offer
- The difference between being watched and being truly seen

AT A GLANCE

TARGET PLATFORM	TV One (primary)
SECONDARY FIT	BET+, then OWN / Lifetime
SETTING	Atlanta, GA, present day
STATUS	Development, Master V1 draft complete

TONE & VISUAL STYLE

Grounded and analog-tactile against a backdrop of quiet, institutional menace: darkroom process, developer trays, contact sheets, film held to light, as a recurring visual language of proof and memory, set against the clean, camera-studded surfaces of a city being renovated in real time. Golden hour on the BeltLine gives way to fluorescent civic beige and carbon-arc stage light. Atlanta is filmed as a character with a memory longer than any of its institutions.

PLATFORM FIT

TV One leads first: the network's built a loyal Black adult 25-54 audience on exactly this register, a woman in danger, a methodical predator, a case that gets solved through persistence rather than procedure, the lane *Fatal Attraction* and *Cheaters* already own on Monday nights. EMINENT DOMAIN raises the ceiling on that format with a real theme underneath the thriller engine and an ensemble strong enough to travel. BET+ is the natural second home, its slate already proves an audience for Black excellence and Black struggle in the same story, and this one adds a corporate antagonist and a preservation fight neither network has told yet.

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CAST SUGGESTION DOCUMENT

Suggestions below are calibrated for a TV One lead package first, with BET+ crossover appeal second, each name chosen for range and marketability at the pitch stage, not as attached or approached talent.

Maggie Sullivan

LEAD

29, Black. Photographer and abuse survivor. Quiet steel and an artist's eye, relearning to trust her own perception.

KiKi Layne

Vulnerability and quiet resolve; can carry long wordless stretches this role demands.

Ryan Destiny

Grounded intensity; reads as someone rebuilding in real time, not performing recovery.

Ajiona Alexis

Atlanta-based, rising visibility; built-in regional authenticity for a story this Atlanta-specific.

Taylor Simpson

LEAD

28, Black. Graphic designer and housing-justice organizer, Maggie's oldest friend, learns passion from patience.

Kiersey Clemons

Warmth and comic timing that turns fast into real anger and grief, key for the Act Two fracture.

Reign Edwards

Atlanta ties and strong dramatic work; believable as the friendship's more expressive half.

Alexandra Shipp

Sharp, opinionated energy that fits Taylor's early overreach, and the humility she earns later.

Morrison McGee

ANTAGONIST

43. Security consultant, serial stalker. Not a movie monster, a company man. Lives or dies on stillness.

Jesse Plemons

A career built on exactly this register of banal, procedural menace.

Noah Emmerich

Steady, unassuming, disappears into "the guy nobody remembers," the character's whole method.

Josh Charles

Clean-cut charm that curdles without changing his face; plays mentor as sincerely as hunter.

Ms. Odessa Fair

SUPPORTING

70s, Black. Ashby Grove's matriarch and moral center, commands a room without raising her voice.

Lynn Whitfield

Commanding warmth with real edge; decades of matriarchs played as women, never scenery.

CCH Pounder

Gravitas and dry wit, makes Odessa's one-liners land as hard as her monologues.

Derek Harrison

SUPPORTING

30s. Maggie's ex, volatile, given one real scene of unglamorous shame rather than pure villainy.

Kofi Siriboe

Proven at wounded, complicated men without losing the audience's read on him.

O'Shea Jackson Jr.

Physically imposing with real vulnerability underneath, for Derek's shaken interrogation-room beat.

Mark Chen

SUPPORTING

35. Ex-Marine turned security consultant for the Coalition, Morrison's legitimate mirror.

Harry Shum Jr.

Believable as muscle and moral compass; grounds the late reveal of his personal stakes.

Daniel Wu

Seasoned, grounded presence that reads as competent without needing to prove it.

Elena Worthy

SUPPORTING

45. Owner of the firm that hires Maggie, sharp, impeccable, reckoning with her own complicity.

Sanaa Lathan

Precision and warmth; believable running her own firm and confronting her blind spots.

Nicole Ari Parker

Polish and steel, plays Elena's reckoning with her own convenient answers without a wasted syllable.

This list reflects tone, range, and marketability at the pitch stage only. No actor listed has been attached, approached, or confirmed for this project. Ages and descriptions reference the current draft's character breakdown and are open to adjustment as casting conversations develop.